Sanaul Haque

Adrinasadat_Yasini_Proposal

Course 201

Document Details

Submission ID
trn:oid:::3117:635627112

Submission Date
Oct 7, 2026, 11:01 PM GMT+6

Download Date
Oct 7, 2026, 11:04 PM GMT+6

File Name
Adrinasadat_Yasini_Proposal.pdf

File Size
108.6 KB

6 Pages

1,845 Words

10,947 Characters

17% Overall Similarity

The combined total of all matches, including overlapping sources, for each database.

Match Groups

- **9** Not Cited or Quoted 7%
  Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks
- **3** Missing Quotations 1%
  Matches that are still very similar to source material
- **5** Missing Citation 9%
  Matches that have quotation marks, but no in-text citation
- **0** Cited and Quoted 0%
  Matches with in-text citation present, but no quotation marks

Top Sources

- 11% Internet sources
- 12% Publications
- 14% Submitted works (Student Papers)

Match Groups

- **9** Not Cited or Quoted 7%
  Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks
- **3** Missing Quotations 1%
  Matches that are still very similar to source material
- **5** Missing Citation 9%
  Matches that have quotation marks, but no in-text citation
- **0** Cited and Quoted 0%
  Matches with in-text citation present, but no quotation marks

Top Sources

- 11% Internet sources
- 12% Publications
- 14% Submitted works (Student Papers)

Top Sources

The sources with the highest number of matches within the submission. Overlapping sources will not be displayed.

1	Student papers	
ICSDI on 2026-08-20		2%
2	Internet	
e-journal.unair.ac.id		2%
3	Student papers	
University of Florida on 2023-11-13		2%
4	Publication	
Gandolfo Dominici, Mario Tani, Simone Luongo. "A Kano analysis of food delivery ...		2%
5	Internet	
ir.uitm.edu.my		2%
6	Student papers	
CSU, Fullerton on 2023-12-01		1%
7	Internet	
borneojournal.um.edu.my		1%
8	Student papers	
University of the Sunshine Coast on 2026-06-02		<1%
9	Publication	
Minjun Song, Andres Fielbaum. "The invisible hand of the app: The role of platfor...		<1%
10	Student papers	
Nelson Marlborough Institute of Technology on 2025-06-12		<1%

11 Student papers

Kolej Mara Banting on 2025-02-14 <1%

12 Publication

Flavia Braga Chinelato, Cid Gonçalves Filho. "The bridge between “click” and loyal... <1%

13 Publication

Anwar Allah Pitchay, Yuvaraj Ganesan, Nurul Syifa Zulkifli, Ahmad Khaliq. "Deter... <1%

14 Student papers

Asia Pacific University College of Technology and Innovation (UCTI) on 2026-08-28 <1%

15 Student papers

HELP UNIVERSITY on 2025-11-19 <1%

16 Publication

Si Si Jia, Rebecca Bennett, Adyya Gupta. "The emergence of meal delivery applicat... <1%

IARCO RESEARCH PROPOSAL

Full Legal Name: Adrina Sadat Yasini

Institution: Sunway International School

Category: Junior

Class/Grade/Year: Grade 11

Country: Malaysia

Major (if senior): N/A

Submission Date: September 20, 2026

Registered Email Address: adrinayasini@gmail.com

Research Topic: The Impact of Small Order Fees on Food Delivery Costs in Malaysia

Title: Assessing the Impact of Small Order Fees on the Relative Cost of Food Delivery Orders in Malaysia

Research Problem

Online food delivery platforms provide convenient access to prepared meals, yet the menu price of food does not necessarily represent the final cost paid at checkout. Consumers may encounter delivery fees, service or platform fees, and other mandatory charges. When an order falls below a platform- or restaurant-specific minimum value, an additional small-order fee may also be applied. The economic significance of this charge depends not only on its absolute value but also on the value of the food being purchased. A RM3 fee, for example, represents 25% of a RM12 food subtotal but only 10% of a RM30 subtotal. Therefore, examining small-order fees only in ringgit terms may conceal the disproportionate burden experienced by consumers making lower-value purchases. Existing research has examined online food delivery pricing, consumer adoption, price sensitivity, and additional platform charges [1]-[7]. Malaysian studies, however, have largely focused on consumer attitudes, purchasing behaviour, food choices, and continued use of delivery applications rather than directly measuring small-order fees relative to the underlying food subtotal. This leaves a specific empirical gap: limited evidence quantifies how the proportional burden of small-order fees changes across low-value orders in the Malaysian food delivery market. This study proposes a controlled digital price audit of selected food delivery platforms and restaurants accessible from a fixed Malaysian delivery location. By systematically constructing orders below the applicable minimum-order threshold, recording the displayed small-order fee, and expressing that fee as a percentage of the food subtotal, the study will provide a focused and reproducible measure of the relative burden created by this pricing mechanism.

Existing Literature

Research on online food delivery shows that platform pricing can create a meaningful difference between listed menu prices and the amount ultimately paid by consumers. Pourrahmani, Jaller, and Fitch-Polse [1] examined pricing across major food delivery applications in the United States and identified delivery, service, and small-order fees as important components of total purchase cost. Their work demonstrates why platform charges should be examined separately from food prices when evaluating the economic cost of delivery. Jia et al. [2], in a systematic mapping review of online food delivery environments, also identified variation in food and delivery pricing and highlighted price as an important influence on consumer choice. These studies establish that platform-level pricing mechanisms matter, but findings from other markets cannot automatically be assumed to describe Malaysian fee structures. Malaysian research has mainly approached

online food delivery from a consumer-behaviour perspective. Pitchay et al. [3] examined determinants of customers' intention to use delivery applications, while Md Pazil, Amran, and Che Hussin [4] investigated factors affecting consumers' selection of online food delivery services. Chan and Moy [5] examined usage among a Malaysian working population, and Teo, Liew, and Lim [7] studied continuance purchase intention. Across this literature, price and perceived value are relevant to consumers' decisions. Relatively modest transaction values are also relevant in Malaysia. Eu and Sameeha [6] reported that 43.1% of the public-university students in their sample spent RM15-RM19 per online food delivery transaction, including delivery fees. At such order values, even a small fixed charge may account for a noticeable share of expenditure. The literature therefore supports two premises: additional platform charges can materially affect delivery costs, and Malaysian consumers respond to price and value. What remains less directly examined is the proportional burden of the small-order fee itself. The present study addresses this narrower gap by observing platform-displayed charges directly rather than relying on consumers to recall or estimate them.

Research Question

To what extent does the relative burden of small-order fees increase as the food subtotal decreases below the applicable minimum-order threshold on selected food delivery platforms accessible from a fixed delivery location in Malaysia?

Methodology

This study will use a quantitative observational design based on a controlled digital price audit. The unit of analysis will be a simulated food delivery order constructed within a selected platform-restaurant combination. No purchase is required; pricing information will be recorded from the checkout screen before final order placement. This design measures displayed fee structures directly rather than consumers' perceptions of them.

Sampling. Two food delivery platforms accessible at the study location will be selected. A purposive sample of 15 eligible restaurants per platform will be targeted, producing 30 platform-restaurant combinations. A restaurant will be eligible only if (1) an identifiable minimum-order threshold is shown, (2) a small-order fee is displayed when the subtotal falls below that threshold, and (3) the menu allows several distinct order values to be constructed below or near the threshold.

Order scenarios. Four primary order scenarios will be created for each eligible platform-restaurant combination, for a target of approximately 120 observations. Because restaurants may use different minimum-order thresholds, the scenarios will be defined relative to each restaurant's threshold rather than by one universal ringgit value. The researcher will attempt to construct orders at approximately 25%, 50%, 75%, and as close

as practicable to 100% of the threshold while remaining below it. The exact obtainable food subtotal and its percentage of the threshold will be recorded for every observation. Where menu-price increments prevent close matching, no artificial adjustment will be made.

Data collection. The same delivery location and, as far as technically possible, the same account and delivery settings will be maintained throughout the collection. Each observation will record platform, restaurant, date and time, selected items, food subtotal, minimum-order threshold, small-order fee, delivery fee, service/platform fee, other mandatory charges, promotional discount, and final displayed checkout price. A screenshot of the relevant checkout information will be retained as an audit trail.

Promotions and exclusions. Promotional discounts, vouchers, credits, subscriptions, or membership benefits will not be treated as reductions in the underlying small-order fee. If an automatically applied promotion cannot be removed, it will be documented separately. Observations will be excluded when the small-order fee or minimum-order threshold cannot be clearly identified. If a sampled restaurant becomes unavailable, the reason will be logged and an eligible replacement will be selected using the same criteria.

Primary measure. For each eligible order, the Relative Small-Order Fee Burden (RSFB) will be calculated as: RSFB = (Small-Order Fee / Food Subtotal) x 100. This converts the fee into a common percentage measure and allows orders with different monetary values to be compared.

Analysis. Descriptive statistics will summarize RSFB using the mean, median, minimum, maximum, range, and interquartile range. A scatter plot will display food subtotal relative to the minimum-order threshold against RSFB. Summary tables will compare fee burdens across the four planned order positions. Platform-level comparisons will be reported descriptively where the samples are sufficiently comparable. Delivery fees, service fees, and other charges will be recorded for context but will not be incorporated into RSFB because the central research question concerns the small-order fee specifically.

Reliability. All observations will be entered into a standardized spreadsheet, and the RSFB calculation will use one fixed formula. Timestamps and screenshots will permit later verification. A subset of records will be checked against the original screenshots before analysis to identify transcription errors.

Project practicalities and Ethics

The project is feasible for a junior researcher because data can be collected digitally without recruiting human participants or visiting restaurants. The principal resources required are access to the selected delivery applications, a spreadsheet program, and

secure storage for screenshots. No order needs to be completed and no personal information from other individuals will be collected. The project is expected to require approximately four to six weeks. The first week will be used to pilot the sampling and recording procedure. The following two to three weeks will be used for systematic data collection, followed by data cleaning, RSFB calculation, descriptive analysis, graph construction, and interpretation.

Roadblock and Potential Limitations

Small-order fees, thresholds, menu prices, and other platform charges may change over time. The findings will therefore describe the pricing conditions observed during the defined collection period rather than permanent platform policies. Recording timestamps will make this limitation transparent. Pricing may also vary by delivery location, restaurant, account status, demand conditions, or other factors that are not fully visible to the researcher. A fixed delivery location and consistent account conditions will reduce this variation but cannot eliminate it. For this reason, the study will not claim that the sample statistically represents every food delivery transaction in Malaysia. Restaurant menus may not permit identical subtotals across observations. Recording the exact subtotal and its position relative to each minimum threshold addresses this problem more appropriately than forcing identical ringgit values. Purposive sampling is also necessary because the research question applies specifically to restaurants that display an identifiable small-order fee, but this means restaurants without such fees are outside the study's scope. Finally, total checkout cost can also be affected by delivery fees, service fees, promotions, and menu-price differences. These will be documented but separated from the primary RSFB measure so that the study can isolate the pricing mechanism named in the research question.

References

[1] E. Pourrahmani, M. Jaller, and D. T. Fitch-Polse, "Modeling the online food delivery pricing and waiting time: Evidence from Davis, Sacramento, and San Francisco," Transportation Research Interdisciplinary Perspectives, vol. 21, Art. no. 100891, Sep. 2023, doi: 10.1016/j.trip.2023.100891.

[2] S. S. Jia et al., "Offline to online: A systematic mapping review of evidence to inform nutrition-related policies applicable to online food delivery platforms," BMC Medicine, vol. 22, Art. no. 542, 2024, doi: 10.1186/s12916-024-03747-8.

[3] A. A. Pitchay, Y. Ganesan, N. S. Zulkifli, and A. Khaliq, "Determinants of customers' intention to use online food delivery application through smartphone in Malaysia," British Food Journal, vol. 124, no. 3, pp. 732-753, 2022, doi: 10.1108/BFJ-01-2021-0075.

[4] A. H. Md Pazil, N. Amran, and K. Che Hussin, "The Decision Factors in Online Food Delivery Services Selection during the COVID-19 Pandemic," Journal of Entrepreneurship and Business, vol. 11, no. 2, pp. 45-55, 2023, doi: 10.17687/jeb.v11i2.936.

[5] L. Y. Chan and F. M. Moy, "Online Food Delivery Services Usage and Its Associated Factors Among a Work Population in a Middle Income Country, Malaysia," Journal of Health and Translational Medicine (JUMMEC), vol. 28, no. 1, 2025, doi: 10.22452/jummec.vol28no1.3.

[6] N. A. Eu and F. M. Sameeha, "Consumers' Perceptions of Healthy Food Availability in Online Food Delivery Applications (OFD Apps) and Its Association With Food Choices Among Public University Students in Malaysia," Frontiers in Nutrition, vol. 8, Art. no. 674427, 2021, doi: 10.3389/fnut.2021.674427.

[7] S. C. Teo, T. W. Liew, and H. Y. Lim, "Factors influencing consumers' continuance purchase intention of local food via online food delivery services: the moderating role of gender," Cogent Business & Management, vol. 11, no. 1, Art. no. 2316919, 2024, doi: 10.1080/23311975.2024.2316919.